

6.3 Mobile TV

On 26 November 2004, Nokia welcomed the announcement by the European Telecommunications Standards Institute (ETSI) that DVB-H (Digital Video Broadcast—Handheld) is to be adopted as the standard in Europe for mobile TV services.

DVB-H is a new technology that enables the simultaneous transmission of multiple television, radio and video channels to mobile handheld devices. It combines traditional broadcasting standards with specific features for handheld devices. To receive DVB-H transmissions, handsets require an additional integrated receiver. Nokia plans to bring a commercial mobile TV handset with integrated DVB-H to market globally in 2006.

“This announcement is an important step forward in making commercial mobile TV services a reality,” said Richard Sharp, Vice President, Rich Media, Nokia. “DVB-H is a groundbreaking technology that will facilitate the widespread adoption of mobile TV around the world. We are delighted that ETSI has adopted the DVB-H standard for Europe and started the trend for the global adoption of DVB-H.”

Mobile TV presents a number of unique challenges, such as battery-powered receivers and a variety of situations of use (e.g. indoor, outdoor, pedestrian, inside moving vehicle). DVB-H provides the most efficient way of carrying multimedia services over digital terrestrial broadcasting networks to handheld terminals.

To overcome these challenges, DVB-H uses a variety of techniques including time-slicing to reduce a device’s average power consumption, cell identifiers to support quicker signal scan and frequency handover as well as methods to improve signal strength in the mobile environment. The technical specification work has been done in the Digital Video Broadcasting Project (DVB), which is an industry-led consortium committed to designing global standards for the global delivery of digital television and data services.